

The top took the week down

The first down week of the run, and the weight sat at the top. **Equal weighted fell 0.50 percent against the headline at 1.43**, and **gold rose 6.72 percent**.

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01 The week

Where the week finished, at the Friday August 21 settle.

-1.43% S&P 500, week	-2.45% Nasdaq 100, week	-1.62% Russell 2000, week	15.16 VIX, from 14.25	4.74% US 10 year	+6.72% Gold, week
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Four down sessions and one up. The S and P futures opened at 7,809 and settled at 7,691.

MON 17 ES 7,769 Week high 7,824 then gives it all back HIGH	TUE 18 ES 7,714 Falls 55 more, NQ loses 30,000 SLIDE	WED 19 ES 7,729 Only up day, recovers 15 points TURN	THU 20 ES 7,663 Week low 7,658, oil peaks 89.00 LOW	FRI 21 ES 7,691 Reclaims 7,700, gold closes at its high CLOSE
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Green top closed higher, red lower.

02 The top

- **Cap weighted** (the S and P 500 you see quoted, where big companies count for more) fell **1.43 percent**; the **same 500 weighted equally** fell only **0.50 percent**. That is **twice running**, a rising market last week and a falling one this.
- The **Nasdaq 100 fell 2.45 percent** and **gave back the 30,000 it cleared the week before**, while **breadth** (how many companies join a move) held up. **The selling was concentrated at the top**.

03 The read

- **Gold rose 6.72 percent to 4,675 dollars**, closing at its high; **WTI** (West Texas Intermediate, the US crude benchmark) **added 5.13 percent**, a second straight 5 percent week. **Both are costs, not growth**.
- **VIX** (the expected swing over the next month, from options) **rose 14.25 to 15.16**, higher and still not fear. **A down week led by the largest companies, with the average one holding up, is rotation not retreat**.

SOURCES & NOTE

Sources: Yahoo Finance daily bars, August 17 to 21 2026. Equal weighted is RSP. Audit: 08-weekly/2026-08-23-recap.md. Educational, not financial advice.

Glossary

Cap weighted Bigger companies count for more.

Equal weighted Every company counted the same.

Breadth How many companies join a move.

Futures A deal to buy or sell later, priced now.